



radha iyer

u. penn masters of architecture '28

iradha@upenn.edu | (425) 504 - 0511

spring 2026	recipe pavilion	2nd place, schenk woodman comp.	2	collaborative work with Ella Matthews, Ian Zang all drawings own	
fall 2025	museum extension	univ. of pennsylvania arch 521	6	individual work	
	watering the plants	univ. of pennsylvania arch 501	8	individual work	
fall 2023	sfsu lca	ehdd + carbon leadership forum	9	collaborative work with ehdd all drawings own	
spring 2023	cultural kitchen	univ. of washington arch 402	11	collaborative design-build with studio + Prof. Steve Badanes	
spring 2022	albuquerque a.d.u.	univ. of washington arch 321	15	individual work	
fall 2021	precedent: chur	univ. of washington arch 300	16	collaborative work with Jorge Burke, Oleh Fylyk	
fall 2022	master planning	univ. of washington urbdp 498	17	individual work	



concept collage/diagram:
passing down a recipe

food and nature bring together generations: every child loves their grandmother's recipes and the smell of freshly picked herbs.

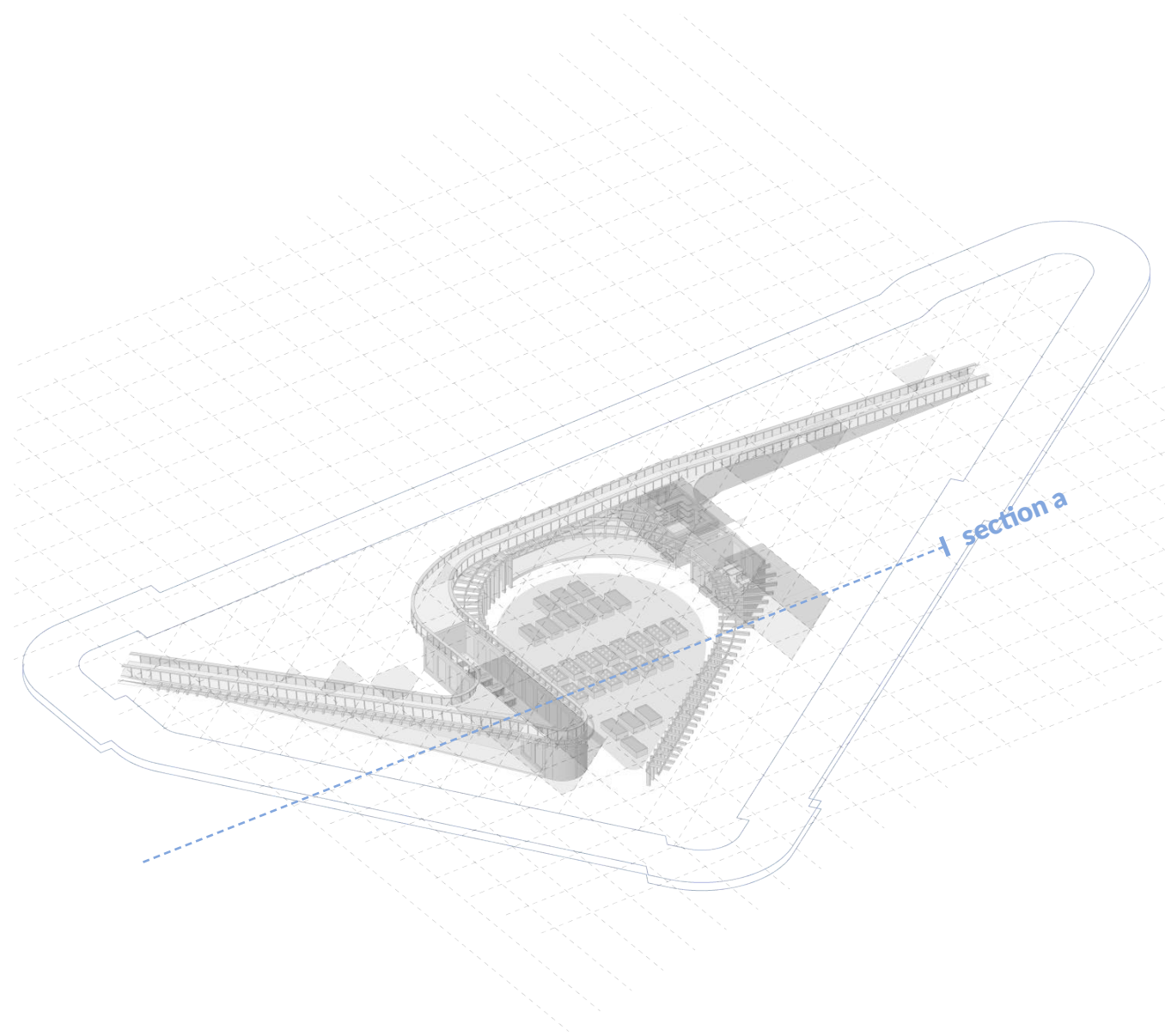
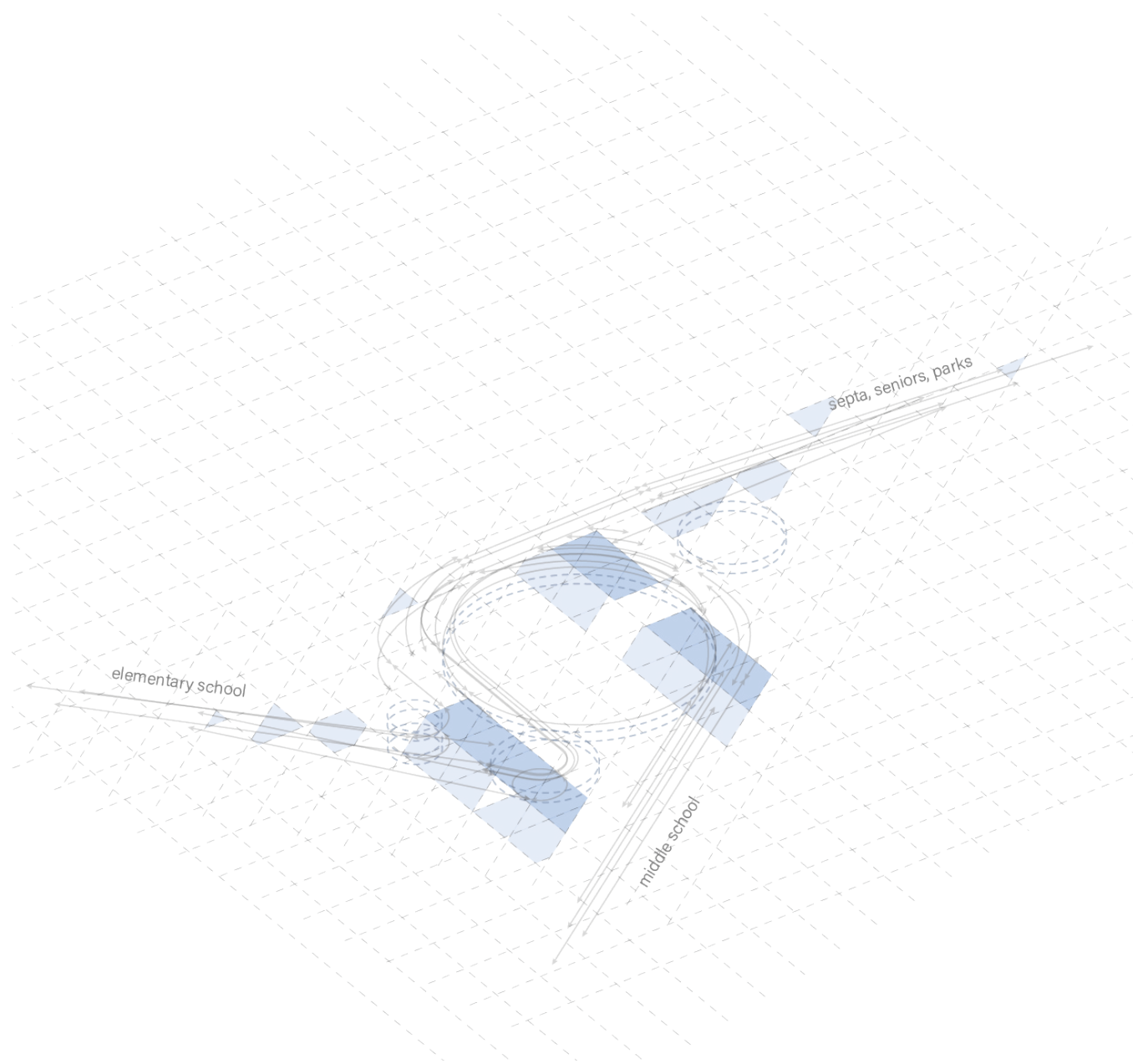
Blanche A. Nixon Library
project site + programming

this pavilion is an intervention on the site of a library in Cobb's Creek, in West Philadelphia. The librarian requested our program

include both senior and youth programming and so we combined the two through food and nature: gardening, and cooking classes..

recipe: a pavilion to share the joy of food. 2nd place, Penn Schenk-Woodman competition

competition, spring 2026



form-finding diagram:
the site + its occupants

the four blocks surrounding the project site have an elementary school, a middle school, a transit stop, and parks. Our form is derived from their circulation.

site axonometric diagram:
flowing around a garden

the competition prompt required that the enclosed structure have very little roof area but still fully secure the site. we used ramps to create this enclosure,



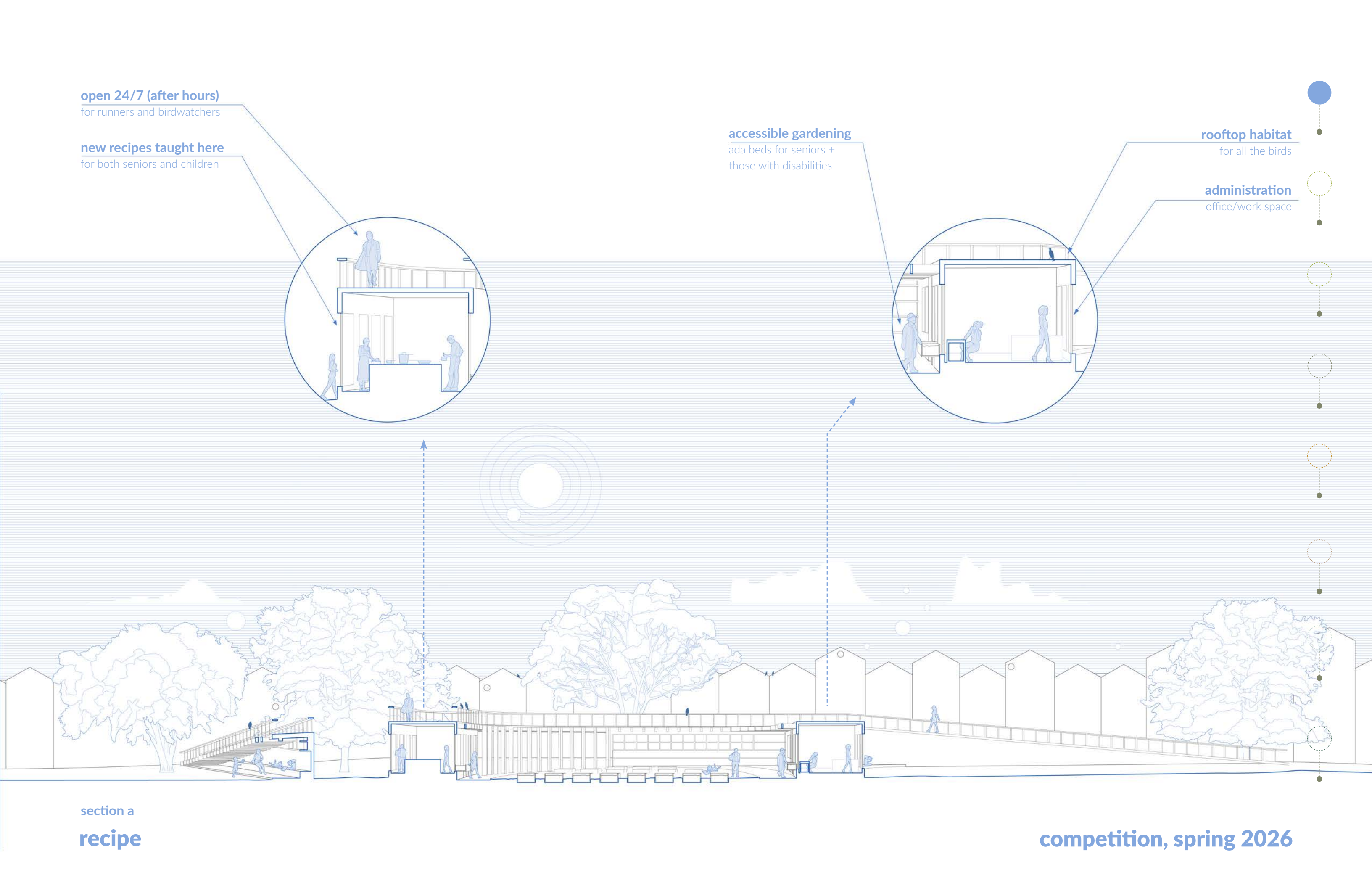
open 24/7 (after hours)
for runners and birdwatchers

new recipes taught here
for both seniors and children

accessible gardening
ada beds for seniors +
those with disabilities

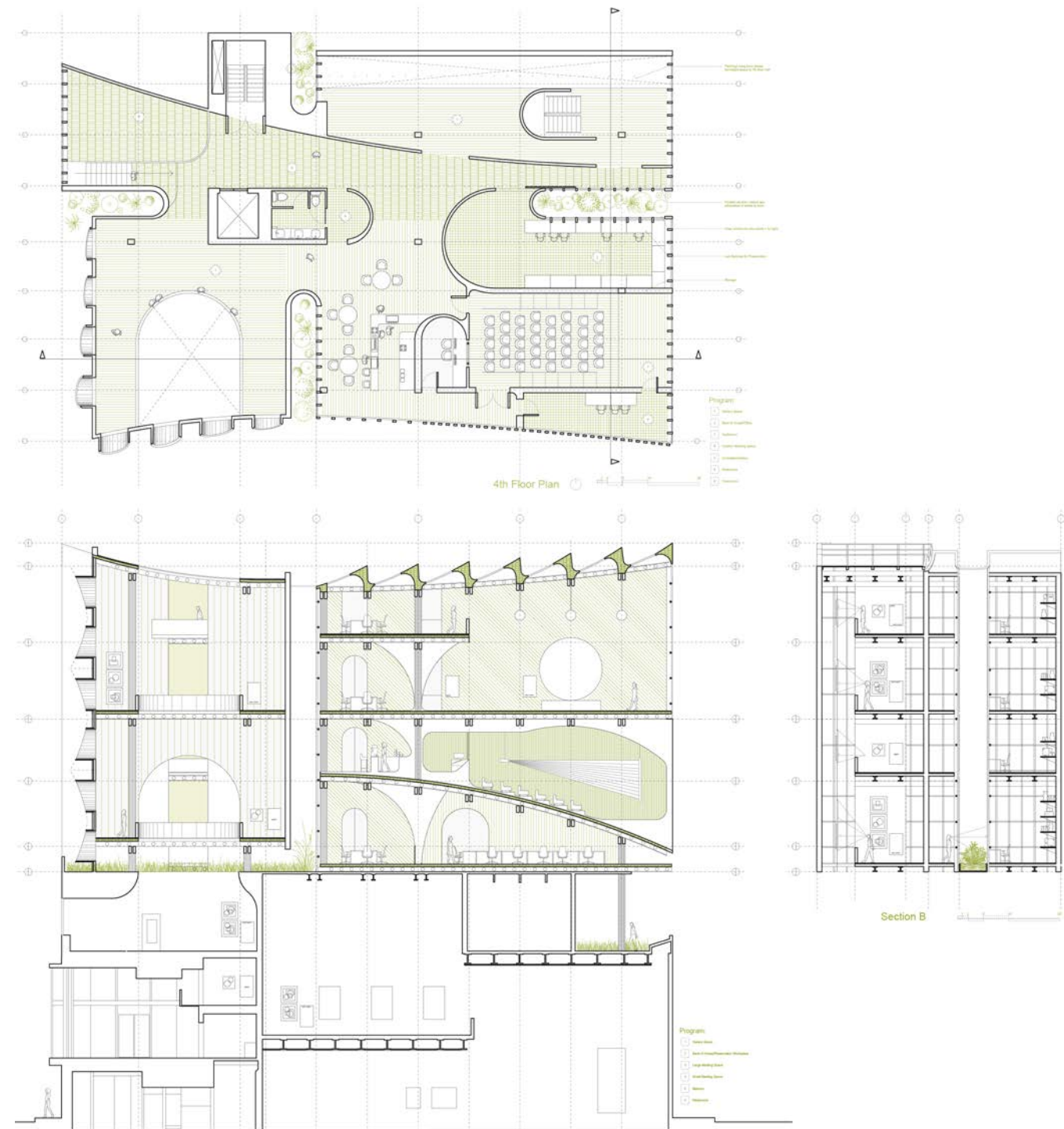
rooftop habitat
for all the birds

administration
office/work space



section a
recipe

competition, spring 2026



cutting space with light:

a vertical extension to the institute of contemporary art. In plan and section, 5' circles divide space, 10' circles create smaller private spaces, 20' circles allow in light

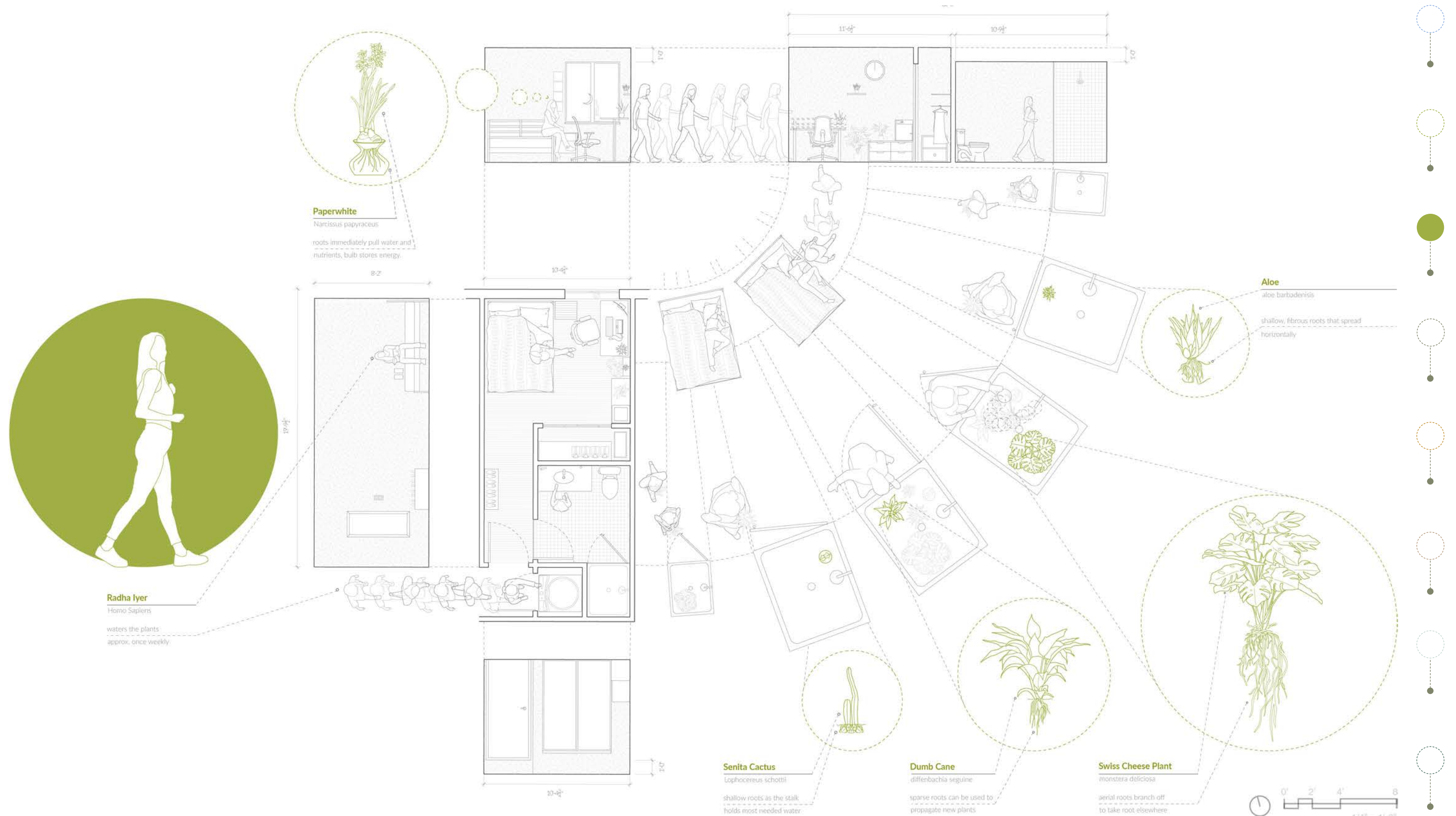
or create shared public spaces, shaping movement with light. Program includes back-of-house space for art preservationists, a multipurpose gallery/event space, and a small auditorium.

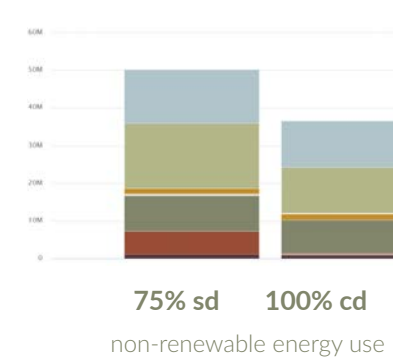
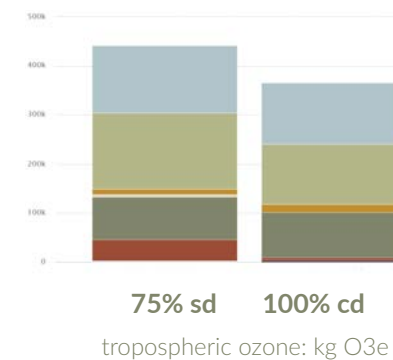
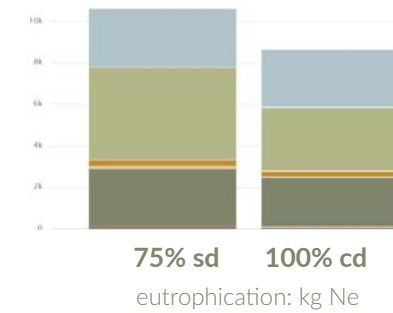
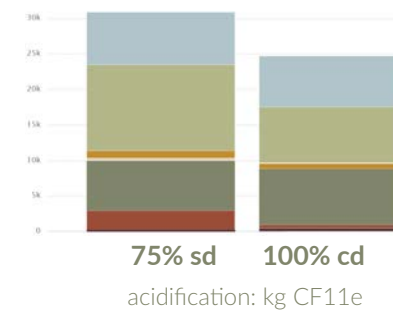
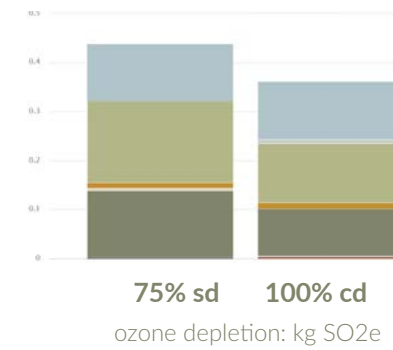
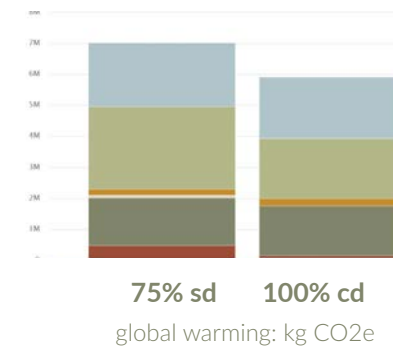


gallery perspective view

ica extension: a vertical extension for the institute of contemporary art, Philadelphia.

arch 501, fall 2025





what categories are here?

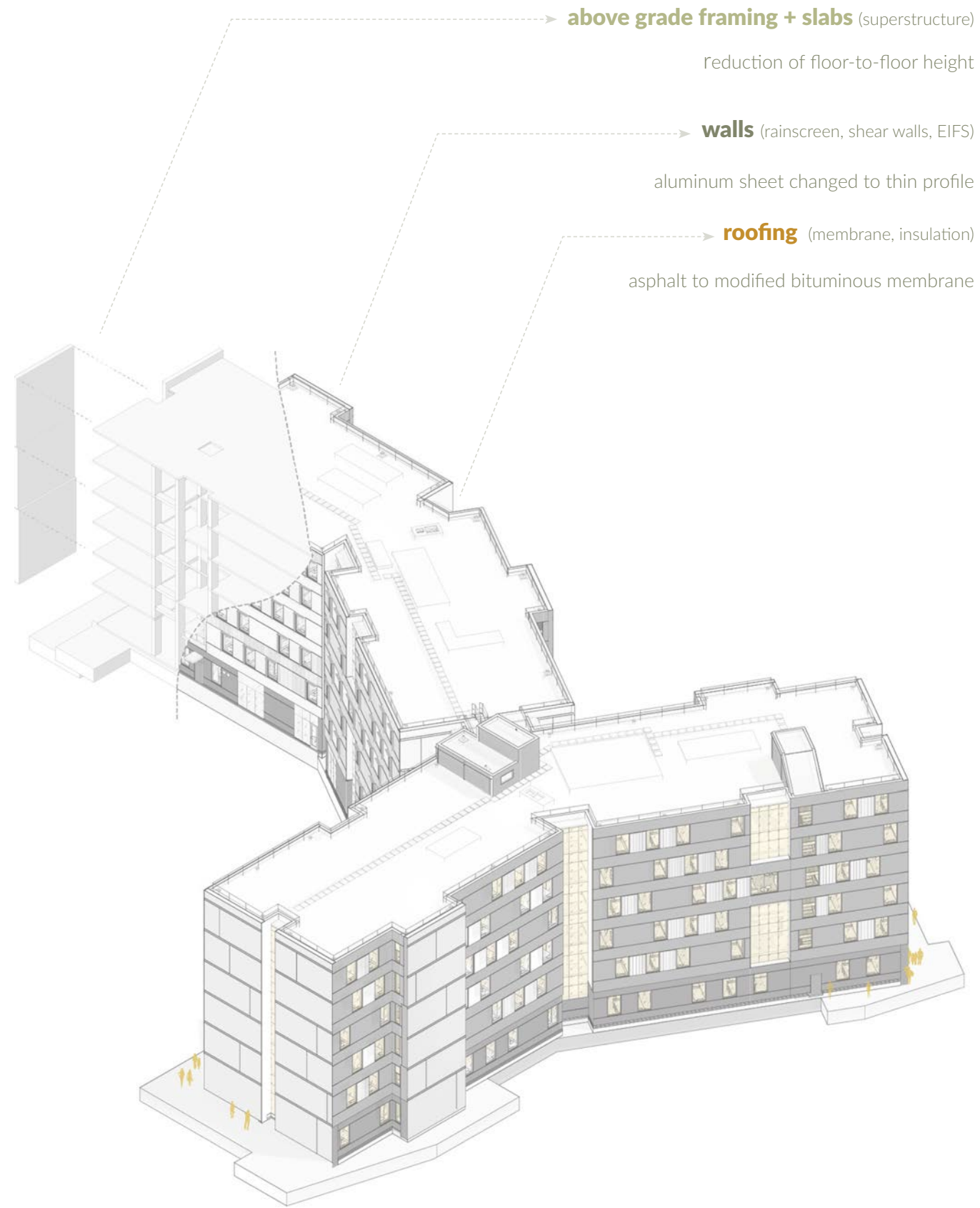
the six impact categories at left are ways our buildings contribute to the atmosphere/environment. the metrics are shown below each graph. there are more impact categories we can measure, LEED recognizes these six though.

LEED v4.1 M+R Credit: WB Life Cycle Assessment

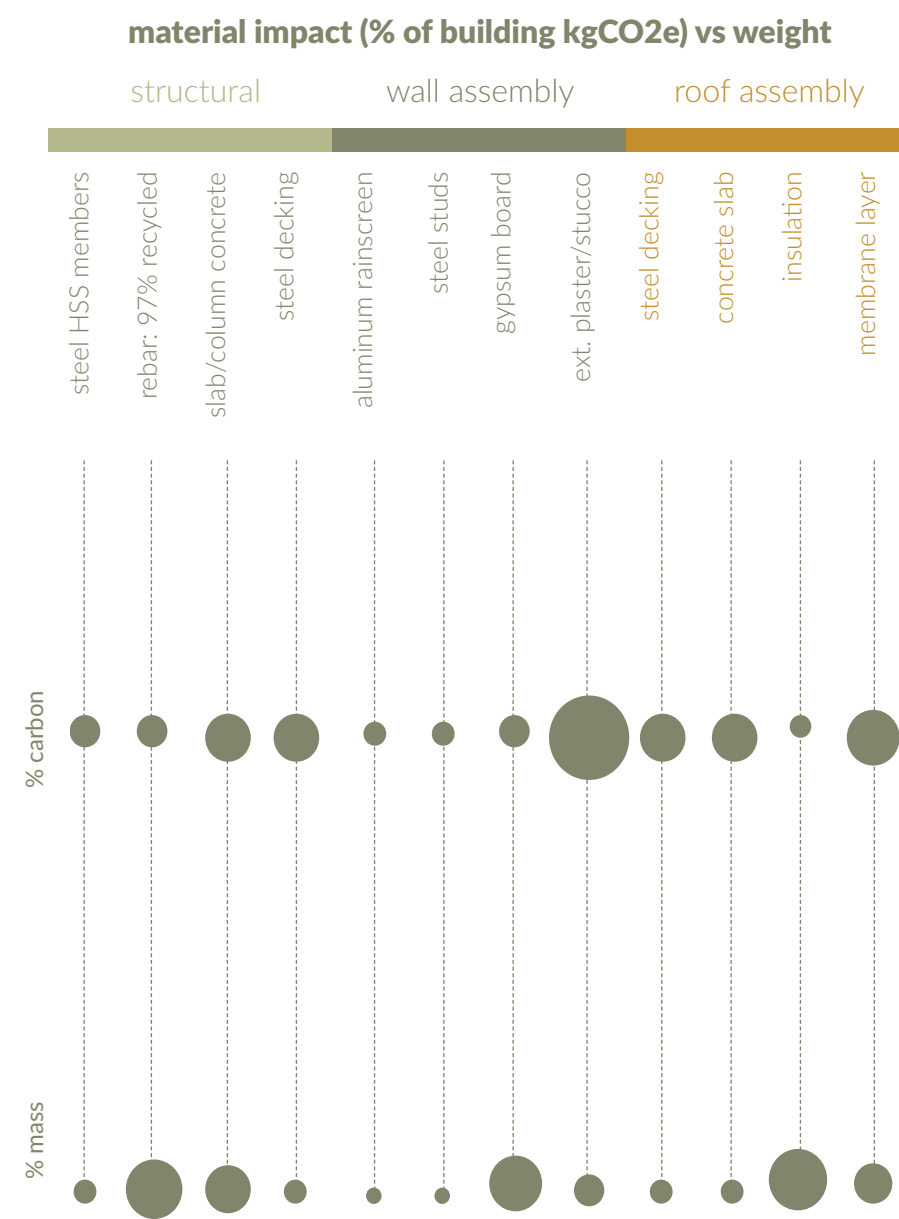
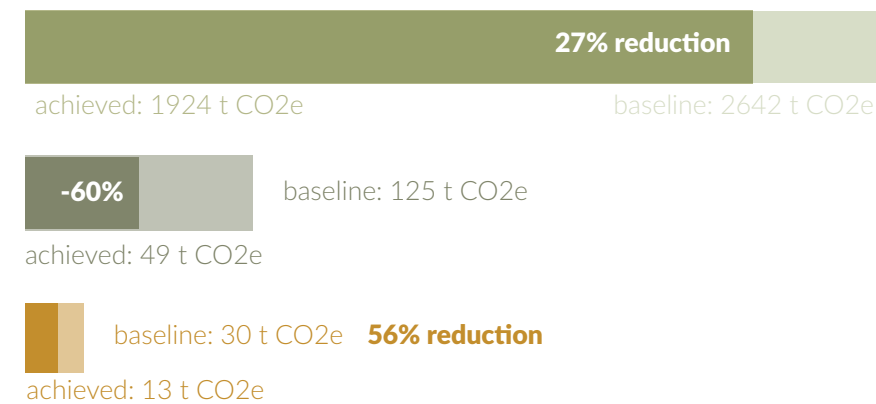
the six graphs above show life cycle impact reduction by category(embodied carbon, ozone depletion, and so on) from the 75% SD to the 100% CD model.

ehdd usually contracts out all life cycle assessment work to a LEED consultant. in this first in-house life cycle study, I explored new ways of visualizing data. rendering + revit model in collaboration with ehdd, data + diagrams all my own work.

- foundation elements
- structural framing/slabs
- sheathing + flashing
- stairs
- exterior walls
- exterior windows



sfsu housing lca



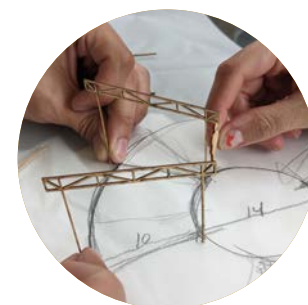
ehdd + carbon leadership forum

where can we cut carbon?

the graph at left is an alternate visualization of the largest reductions in embodied carbon (t CO₂e) by building component.

and by which materials?

the graph at left vizualizes, in abstract fashion, the percent embodied carbon of each material compared to its percent mass in the building.



step 1. stick model



step 2. truss prefabrication



step 3. welding columns



step 4. panel prefabrication



step 5. sitework



step 6. chunk assembly



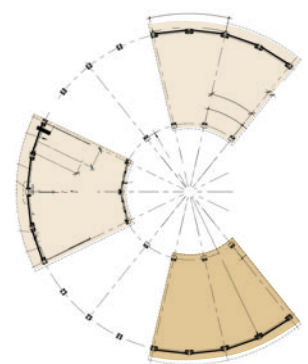
step 7. connecting chunks



step 8. gravel + watering it in



step 9. celebration

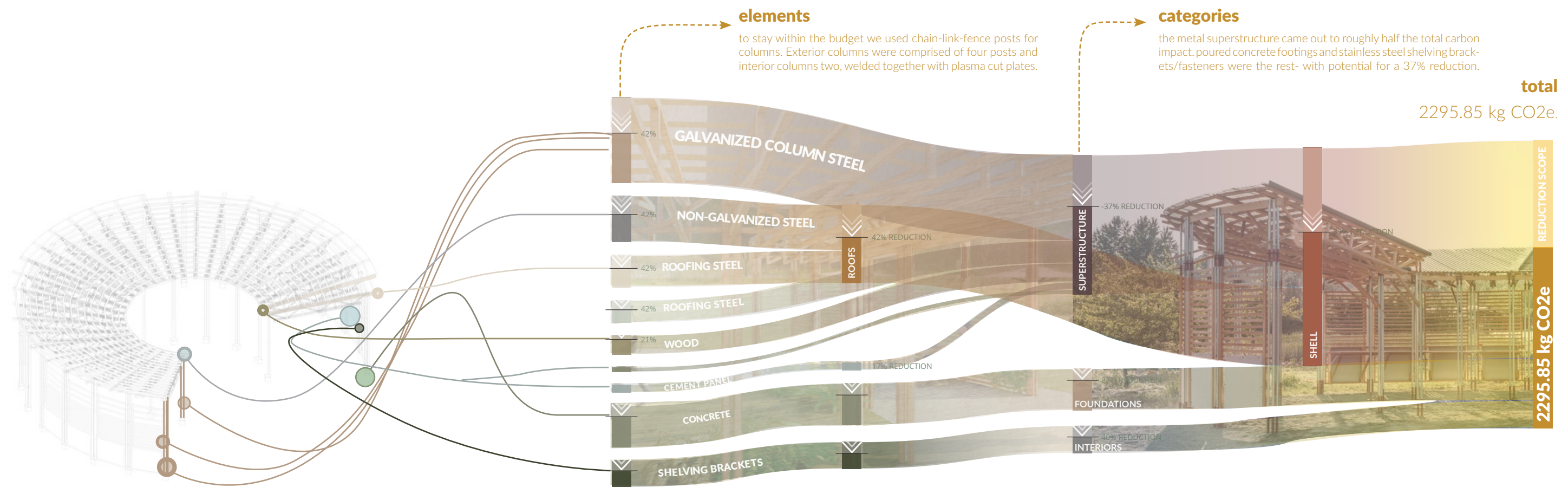


program + the uw farm:

the campus urban farm at the univ. of washington requested our studio build a gathering space for classes and cooking as their programming expanded.

credits for studio work:

team of 16 students and 3 profs led by Prof. Steve Badanes (pictured in step 9). my role was initial sitework coordination with the uw farm and roof detailing.



life cycle assessment 2:

all materials were procured locally from around the Seattle area, and as this was a design-build, we had granular control over what materials we were purchasing.

this study was done retroactively to see if we could have lowered emissions further than we did. The galvanized column steel was the largest contributor to energy, and understandably so, as the structure was wood.

138
propane
cylinders

50 trees
growing
10 years

8 months
straight of
driving a car





environmental systems

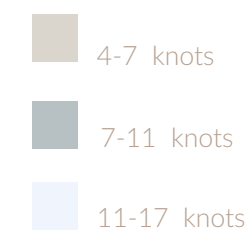
arch 451 is UW env. systems. an environmentally responsive building begins by mapping the climate - sun, wind, rain, humidity.

n



s

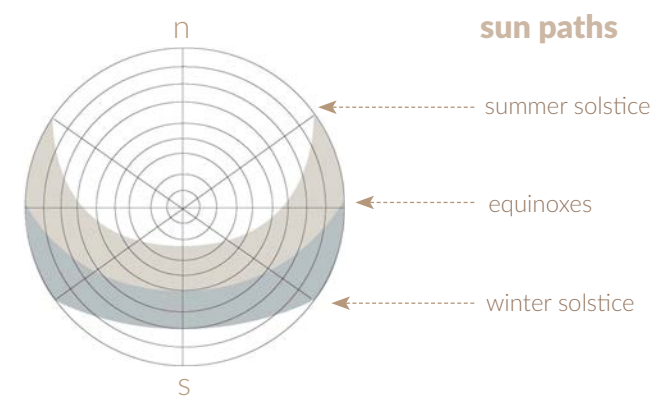
wind speed/direction



wind speed + massing

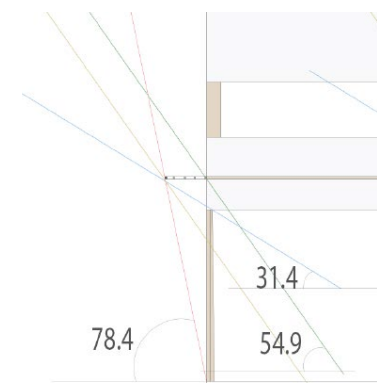
the winds that come primarily from the south and southwest inform our decision to curve the back wall of the adu.

sun paths



sun paths + design

the sun-paths inform the shading device designing shown below.



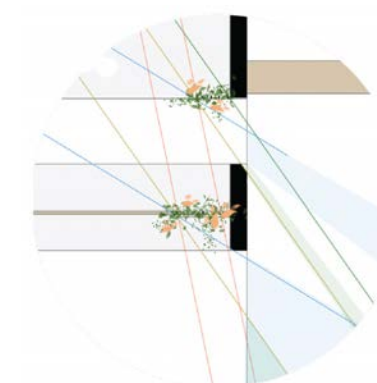
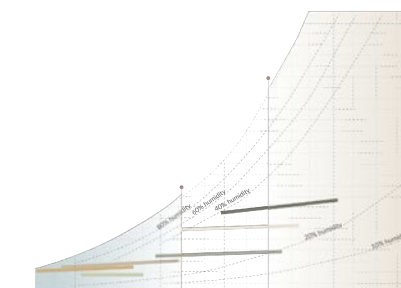
shading device design

angles of shading trellis based off of sun altitude at solar noon, calculated using the following equation:

$$A = 90 - \text{latitude} + \text{declination}$$

$$\begin{aligned} \text{december} &= 90 - 35.1 - 23.5 = 31.4 \\ \text{june} &= 90 - 35.1 + 23.5 = 78.4 \\ \text{sept} = \text{march} &= 90 - 35.1 = 54.9 \end{aligned}$$

temp/humidity



adaptive shading: plants

vegetation on a trellis is used to adaptively shade the glazing at the angles calculated above, as shown by diagram top right.

temperature + mass

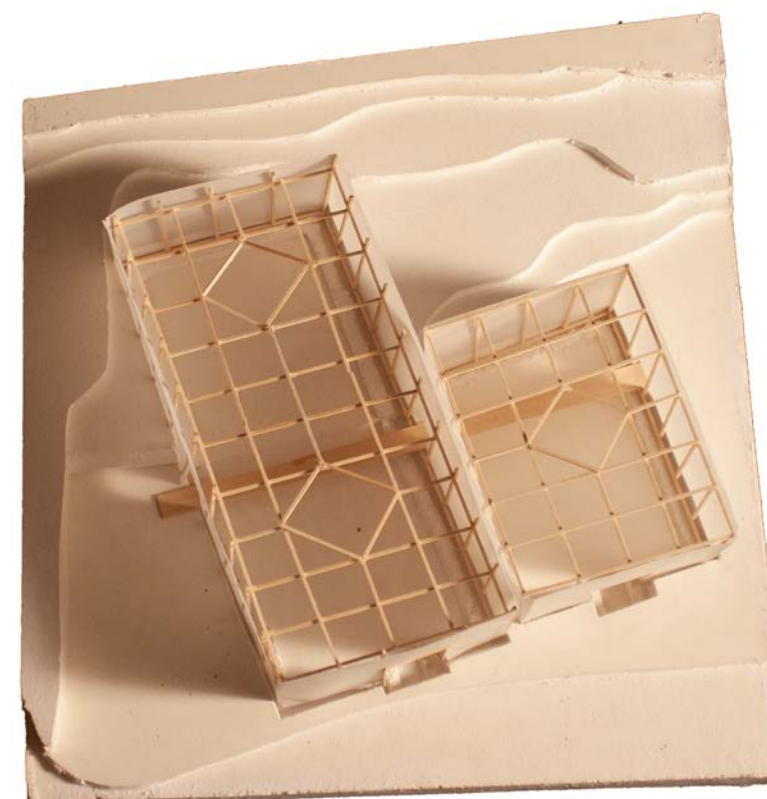
the day-night temperature and humidity swings and the high temperatures indicated above point to a high-mass building..



plaster base



wooden framework



wooden framework + trace shell (above), paper roofs (below)



credit for studio work:

plaster base formwork: self
plaster pouring: oleh fylyk
slats on outside: jorge burke
wooden framework: self

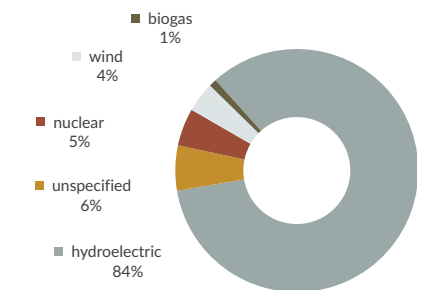
skeleton and skin

peter zumthor's shelter for roman ruins in chur, switzerland, encapsulates the ruins of a roman structure in a thin wooden skeleton wrapped with a skin of wood slats. A suspended aperture allows in light. a 1/16" massing model and a 1/2" scale section model.

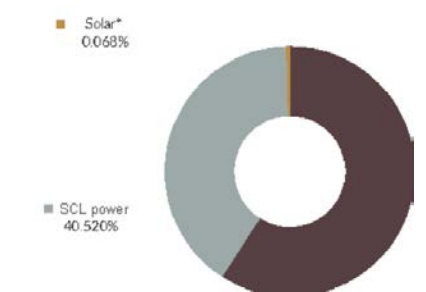


energy consumption

obtaining accurate energy data for every building on campus was difficult as many still run on pneumatic controls. to counter this, we checked data for each building against others of the same age. energy consumption graphed at left.

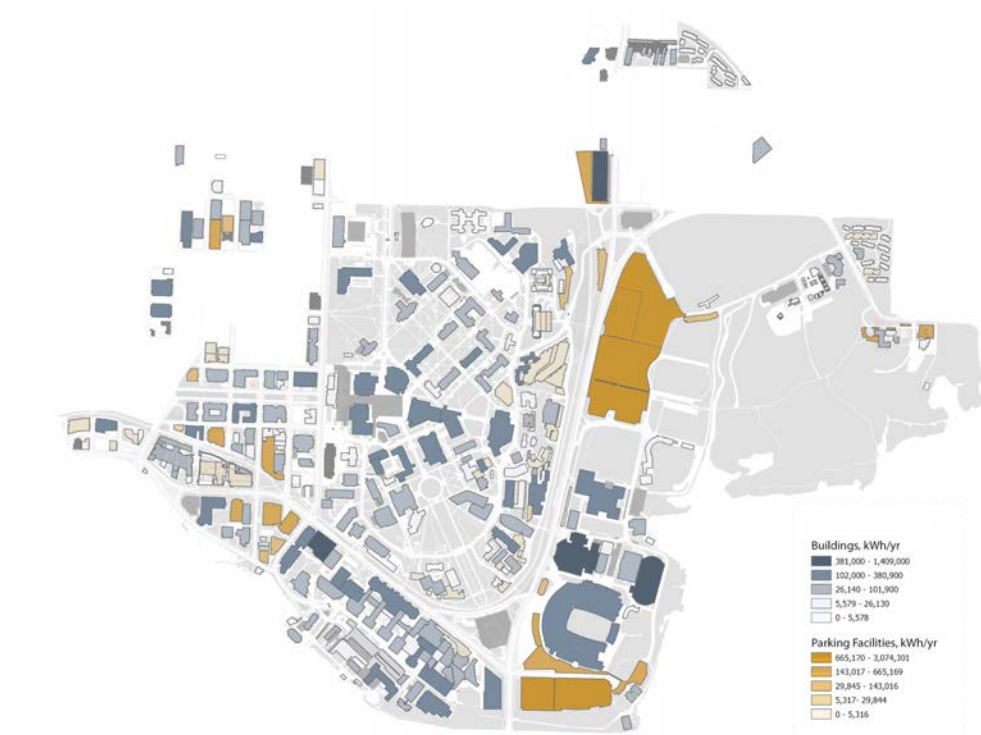


seattle city light power mix



u. of washington power mix

the University's grid is heavily reliant on fossil fuels: transmission infrastructure caps the amount of electricity purchased from the city at roughly 40% of current power use (which will decrease as the university grows and demand increases further). the remainder of power is generated by the on-campus natural gas power and steam plant. Solar can offset this.



pv generation potential

the generation potential for each building is, mainly, a factor of total usable roof area and of shading. NREL's PVWatts system assisted in providing the data in this graph. note the higher generation numbers for parking lots - this is due to sheer area.



solar ranking

a factor of building roof age, date of completion, shading, historic designation, and roof area, the solar ranking of each building is shown at left. "A" buildings are ones on which construction of an array can begin immediately. "C" and "D" buildings are worse.



solar offset

solar generation potential relative to energy consumption is the solar offset. for buildings, where there are multiple stories of high consumption use, solar typically offsets less than 20% of full building energy use.



energy consumption

map intentionally re-iterated from previous page for emphasis. obtaining accurate energy data for every building on campus was difficult as many still run on pneumatic controls. to counter this, we checked data for each building against others of the same age. energy consumption graphed at left.